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The leaders of the world's two largest economies will meet Monday, albeit virtually.

THE WEEK AHEAD

Biden, Xi to meet as inflation threatens the economies of both the U.S. and China

When President Joe Biden meets with Chinese leader Xi Jinping, they won't shake hands. It isn't a diplomatic snub. They two will meet virtually instead of in person. But the question for investors is whether they will see eye-to-eye on inflation.

The two largest economies in the world are experiencing inflationary pains. Higher costs of goods in China, supply chain pinch points in both countries, and a lot of cash sloshing around the U.S. have conspired to help fuel inflation there and here. And sustained higher prices threaten both economies as they work to recover from the pandemic.

It's doubtful inflation is high on the agenda when the two leaders meet, which is expected Monday. China-U.S. relations are strained over national security issues (Taiwan, selling nuclear subs to Australia), human rights issues (cracking down on civil liberties in Hong Kong), and the



BY TOM HUDSON

coronavirus. Inflation should be a topic for the two leaders, though. It is a national security and foreign policy issue for both countries. Inflation may be a monetary phenomenon, but it also can be destabilizing for an economy and devastating for households. Chinese wholesale inflation is at a 26-year high. This means the prices factories in China are paying for materials have shot up. Lots of that stuff coming out of those Chinese factories will be headed to the U.S. — and with higher prices. In October, American consumer prices saw their biggest year-over-year surge in more than 30 years. The Federal Reserve has

stated its higher tolerance for hotter than usual inflation in the effort to spread job gains into more corners of the economy. Increasingly, though, consumers and investors may get jittery about the central bank's ability to contain higher prices before they become more permanently anchored in the economy.

But China has a different worry — overall economic growth. The COVID-bounce back is slowing considerably, pressuring the central government to keep the economy propped up with cheap borrowing and tolerating escalating inflation. The Communist vice grip on China is held in place by an ever-expanding economy.

The U.S. monetary tools to battle inflation — higher interest rates — cannot be exported to fight higher prices on foreign soil. But those higher prices can be imported.

Tom Hudson hosts 'The Sunshine Economy' on WLRN-FM, where he is the president of news. Twitter: @HudsonsView

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TECH TRAIL

speed they could not keep up with. More often, he said, life got in the way.

The same goes for his friends who did not end up immediately getting hired.

"The jobs are there," he said. It is true, as others have stated, that many companies are not willing to take a chance on someone with little or non-traditional experience. Like a former electrician.

"What they're asking on the job description, and what they actually want, are often two different things," Palacios said. "The companies say they are looking for entry level — but they're also asking for 2-3 years experience in the field and/or they want a bachelor's degree."

Sarah Nobe, who hired Tupy in her former job and at RBT, said that is a key for hiring managers here, especially ones new to the area.

"The tech ecosystem is younger in Miami, it's not as established, but I think

there's an interesting pool of talent here," she said.

"A lot are coming from different backgrounds, or a great bootcamp," she added. "And a lot of people who are coming out of those are career changers, so when you have all people of different backgrounds, being open minded enough to say how can their experience add to what building here, build much more diverse thinking around problem solving, so you have richer teams."

PANTHERS, LEVAN CENTER LAUNCH MAGICAL HOCKEY STICK CHALLENGE

The Florida Panthers announced a collaboration this week with the Alan R. Levan | NSU Broward Center of Innovation to launch the 'Magical Hockey Stick Challenge.' It's the Levan Center of Innovation's first-ever corporate challenge, with the goal of identifying local startups with research and projects of note in the sports technology industry.

The challenge is targeting three aspects: the future of wearable technology; fan experience; and consumer insight products.

The 'Magical Hockey Stick Challenge' invites startups, but also individuals, students and groups to answer this open challenge. The deadline to submit an application is Nov. 30. After the application closes, three applicants will be selected as finalists. A winner will be determined from the group of finalists by members of the Florida Panthers executive team and representatives from the Levan Center of Innovation. The winner will receive tickets to an upcoming Panthers game at FLA Live Arena, a custom Panthers jersey and in-game recognition for their winning solution plus, he able to go through the programs at the Levan Center: Ideate, Incubate and Accelerate.

For more information, go to nova.edu/innovation or nbl.com/panthers.

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Ivan Rapin-Smith, a longtime local Miami tech player and director of Watsco Ventures, hired Christopher Palacios out of Wyncode.

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